

Maradona

From perhaps the greatest individual campaign to a disgraceful fall, Diego Maradona saw it all at the World Cup. He would say his first tryst with the tournament in 1982 is best forgotten, as defending champion Argentina was dumped out in the second group stage by Brazil, a match in which he was infamously sent off for kicking João Batista.

However, he made amends by donning the captain's armband and returning the trophy to the South American nation in 1986.

Ten of Argentina's 14 goals were scored or assisted by Maradona in that edition, including the two iconic strikes against England in the quarterfinal.

His 'Hand of God' goal sparked amusement everywhere except in the land of the Three Lions, while his 'Goal of the Century' earned praise for his 60-yard run that left several defenders and the goalkeeper in the dust.

Four years later, he once again led his side to the final, but could not replicate his heroics as Argentina was edged out by West Germany in the final. Maradona's wait for a fairytale finish continued until the next edition, which marked the beginning of a downward spiral.

At the 1994 World Cup in the U.S., he scored his final World Cup goal against Greece in the group stage before testing positive for a performance-enhancing drug. That marked the end of the road in national colours for him, but despite leaving in disgrace, his influence endured for years to come.